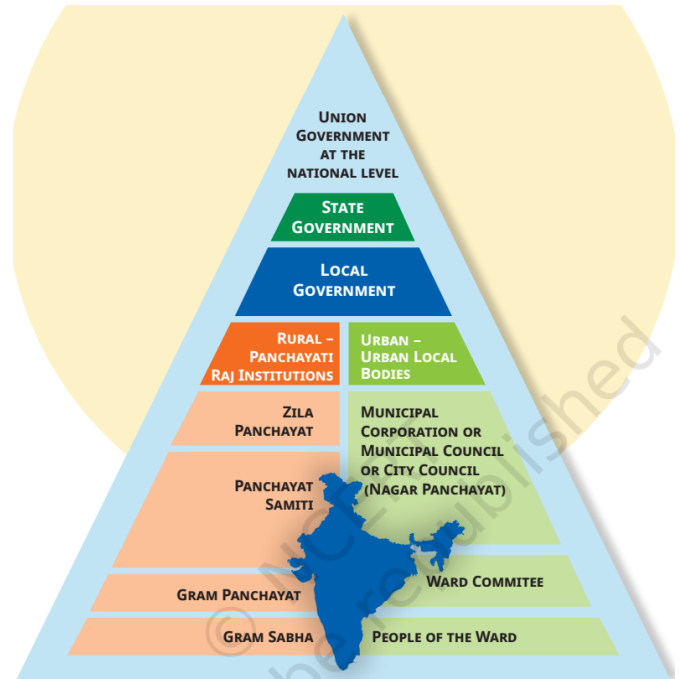


Chapter – 12: Grassroots Democracy – Part 3 – Local Government in Urban Areas

I desire that ... a full-fledged local body should be immediately formed, ... so that people may know really what is an administration, what are the franchise, what are the powers, what are the rights and what are the privileges in a small sphere, in their own town, in their own villages. — Rustom K. Sidhwa, Member, Constituent Assembly (during the Constituent Assembly Debates, 13 October 1949)

Introduction

- Earlier chapters – democracy – good governance – empower citizens – actively participate – country's func. – ruler, regional, urban, state, national level
- This – broader concept – **participatory democracy**
- Basics of sys. – rural context
- Urban scenario – more complex, diverse – governance sys. – more complex
- Before exploring – governance and admin – urban areas – helps – overall look – Indian sys.
- Base of pyramid – local level – closer to people – top – national level
- Previous chapter – left side – this chapter – right side



Urban Local Bodies

- Local govt. – urban areas – urban local bodies
- Decentralized – meaning – instead of operating – under central authority – local communities – direct say – how to manage
- Mechanism – citizens – specific area – come together – take decisions
- Cities, towns – divided – smaller units – wards
- Ward committee – facilitate activities – health camps, campaign against single-use plastic
- Also – check for wrongs – water leak, blocked drain, damaged road, etc. – report to authorities
- Precise func. – wards – differs – State to State – depending on rules
- Urban local bodies – responsible – range of func. – help take care – infrastructure, burial ground, garbage collection, implement govt. schemes, collecting fines, taxes, etc.
- Also plan – economic, social development
- These bodies – perform efficiently – people living – perform their duties
- Example –
 - People – follow instructions – garbage segregation – garbage collection – easier
 - Notice – water leakage – report immediately – prevent wastage

Madras Corporation

- Now Greater Chennai Corporation – estd. – 29th Sept. 1688 – oldest municipal

- East India Company – issued order – previous year – town of ‘Fort St. George’ and 16 km radius – turn into corporation
- Parliamentary Act, 1792 – Madras Corporation got power – levy taxes – municipal administration – properly started
- Services – under IMC – prop. tax, water charges, solid waste mgmt., business and trade licenses, CRM
- CRM – services on request – water tanker, septic tanker, auditorium, funeral van, mobile toilet, ambulance
- Indore, Chennai – Municipal Corporation – at top – population over 10 lakhs – Mahanagar Nigam
- Population – 1 to 10 lakhs – Municipal Council – Nagar Palika
- Cities, towns – smaller populations – Nagar Panchayat
- Conversation – Sameer and Anita –
 - Sameer – you look new to village
 - Anita – visiting grandparents – coming from city – very diff.
 - Sameer – what its like in the city
 - Anita – busy, crowded – tall buildings – people rushing – also noisy – people – not social
 - Sameer – here- everyone knows everyone – help each other – work together – celebrate together – take decisions together
 - Anita – city – some sense of community – other day – house collapsed – 2 streets away – lots of people – helped – clear rubble – make sure – no one trapped
 - Sameer – local govt. should do it
 - Anita – they do it – in fact – we have – local bodies – elected representatives – represent our interest
 - Sameer – that’s similar – village Panchayat – only bigger – members elected – lot of people – participate – discuss issues – even children participate
 - Anita – really – you not making it up
 - Sameer – not at all – other day – few kids notice – elec. wire – hanging very low – we reported it – explained to Gram Sabha members – elec. Pole – shift a little
 - Anita – democracy – works that way – city – more complicated – BUT – idea – same – everyone’s voice matters
 - Sameer – you are right – BUT – I must go – mother needs help – thanks for talking about city
 - Anita – thanks for talking about village – I will look around
 - Sameer – we may meet sometime other